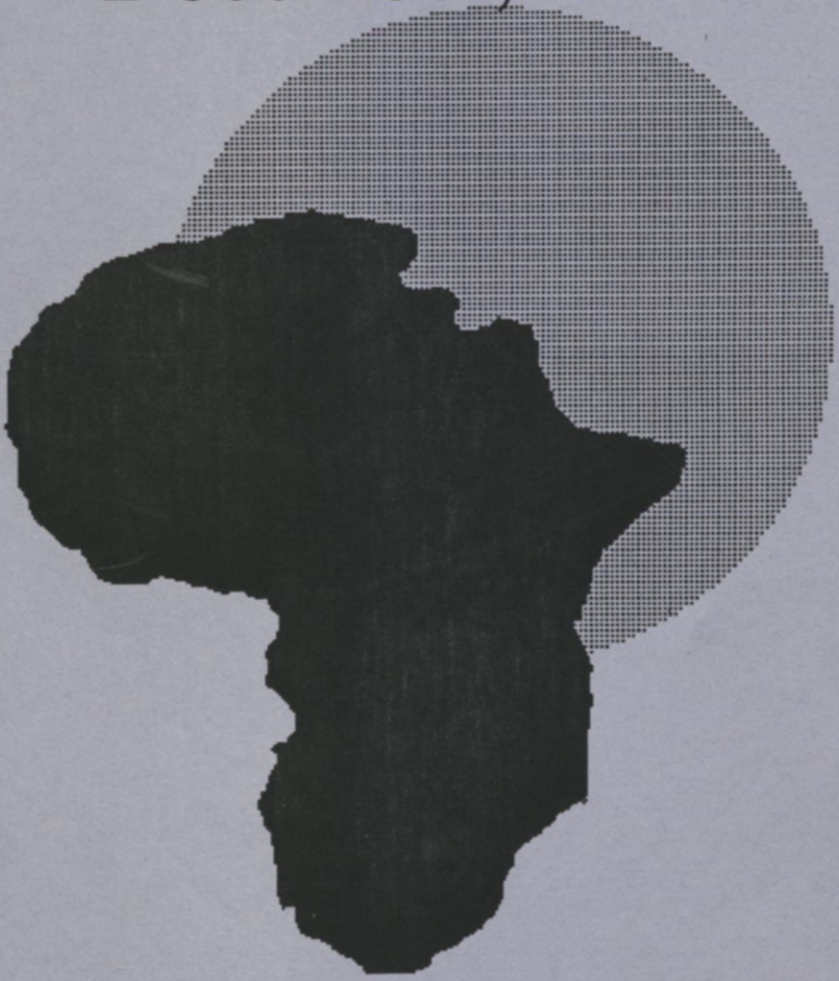
African Sun

December, 1991



Archieves

CELEBRATE KWANZAA!

For the past three decades, Black Americans, disillusioned with the commercialization of Christmas and seeking a time to celebrate our own cultural heritage, have been celebrating Kwanzaa. The term Kwanzaa, which means "fruits of harvest" in Swahili, denotes a time when African communities would join to celebrate the "fruits of their labor". The holiday celebrates the sense of community, family, and collective work that has been an important part of Black cultures throughout the diaspora. Starting on December 26th, the seven principles of Kwanzaa are celebrated:

1. Umoja-unity
2. Kujichagulia-self determination
3. Ujima-collective work and responsibility
4. Ujamaa-cooperative economics
5. Nia-purpose
6. Kuumba-creativity
7. Imani-faith

On each day, a new candle is lit and placed on the *Kinara* (a platform or candle holder), representing the celebrated principal of that day. On January 1st, the final day, there is a feast, the *Karama*, for which each person is encouraged to bring a dish. The *Zawadi*, or gifts, are exchanged. In celebrating Kwanzaa, gift-giving--especially sentimental, useful, creative, or hand-made gifts--can be a meaningful way of demonstrating mutual love and respect. Decorating the home in an African-inspired theme can add to the rich cultural atmosphere that comes along with Kwanzaa principal, are important as well. Extending the Kwanzaa celebration beyond the family to neighbors, friends and the larger community is encouraged.

During a time when attention is often focused on broken ties, generation gaps, and frictions among Black people, it becomes even more important for us to recognize our rich history and our sense of pride and community.

Celebrate!

HISTORICAL EVENTS IN DECEMBER

1, 1955--Rosa Parks, a seamstress and activist, was arrested after she refused to give her seat up to a white man on a Montgomery, Alabama bus.

4, 1906--Alpha Phi Alpha Fraternity, Inc. was founded at Cornell University

5, 1784--Phillis Wheatley, a famous Black poet and the first Black American and first American woman to publish a book, died in Boston.

9, 1961--Tanzania proclaimed its independence.

19, 1875--Carter G. Woodson was born in New Canton, Buckingham County, Virginia.

19, 1910--The first city ordinance requiring separatewhite and Black residential areas was passed by the Baltimore City Council.

Black History at Brown;
Dec 5, 1968-- The Black women attending Pembroke College led a Black a student walkout:

"In protest to the unconcerned, indifferent attitude that this college has toward Black people, we feel that we cannot continue to function under these frustrating circumstances...This walkout is contingent upon compliance with our demands."

The administration promised the recruitment of Black applicants in proportion to the U.S. Black population.

HISTORICAL EVENTS IN JANUARY

1, 1804--Jean Jacques Dessalines proclaimed Haiti's independence from France.

1, 1956--Sudan proclaimed its independence from France.

12, 1952--University of Tennesse admitted its first Black student.

13, 1913--Delta Sigma Theta Sorority, Inc. was founded at Howard University.

15, 1929--Martin Luther King, Jr. was born in Atlanta, Georgia.

31, 1865--Congress passed the 13th Amendment which upon ratification would abolish slavery in the United States.

Before the Mayflower, Lerone Bennet, Jr, 1982 & Brown Daily Herald, Timeline of Third World History at Brown

NEWS

AFRICA

PRESSURE FOR REFORM IN KENYA

President Arap Moi of Kenya, one of Africa's most prominent remaining autocrats, is facing unparalleled pressures for political reform from both abroad and at home. The World Bank has decided to postpone aid to Kenya unless democratic reforms are initiated.

AFRICAN FOR NEXT HEAD OF THE UNITED NATIONS

Deputy Prime Minister Boutros Boutros Ghali of Egypt will become the first African to hold the top post at the UN. Although Ghali was one of the six candidates nominated by the Organization of African Unity (OAU), many of its members would have preferred someone from sub-Saharan Africa for the position . Zimbabwe's Finance Minister Bernard Chidzero was the favorite candidate.

Ghali's age is one of the reasons why some members were against his nomination. He is 67 years old, which means he can only serve one term as Secretary General of the UN.

Dr. Boutros belongs to both Africa and the Middle East. He is a Coptic Christian with a Jewish wife. He is fluent in English, French and Arabic .

SOUTH AFRICA

The first meeting between the government and anti-apatheid organizations was a success . December 20th was the date decided upon by all delegates to begin full scale negotiations toward a democratic, desegregated South Africa. The only organization to boycott the talks was the Conservative Party.

New York Times, International Herald Tribune, The Manchester Guardian, and Voice of America

CARIBBEAN

MONSERRAT

The ruling party of Monserrat was overturned by the newly formed National Progressive Party. The general election had taken place on October 8, a year ahead of schedule because of the resignation of Deputy Chief Minister Benjamin Chalmers, a member of the previous majority party, the People's Liberation Movement. This new party gained four of the seven seats in the Parliament.

Latin America Monitor, November 1991

HAITI

A planned trip was made by Congressman Charles Rangel to inspect the conditions at the U.S. naval base at Guantanamo Bay, Cuba, where hundreds of Haitians are seeking asylum. The base was torpedoed at 11pm, November 17, 1991 by a member of the Bush administration. The government official still has not been revealed.

The refugees have been ordered to return to Haiti. However, the repatriation was halted for at least five days so that further hearings can take place. Many government officials such as Charles Rangel, Floyd Flake and Major Owens have stated that the "Haitians are receiving inhumane treatment due to the fact that they are Black. The Haitians are merely fleeing the persecution and violence in their country and should be granted asylum or temporary extended voluntary departure status."

These officials believe that a program should be adopted where the Haitian "boat people" would be rescued and deportation suspended.

Amsterdam News, Saturday, November 23, 1991

SOUTH AMERICA

BRASIL

Due to the rising numbers of Protestants in Brasil, Pope John Paul II visited the country in mid October. Struck by the level of poverty, the Pope criticized Brasil's economic structure in which 60% of the wealth is controlled by 1% of the population,people of European descent; it is important to note that over 1/2 of all Brasilians are of African descent. He also spoke out against the government's apathy toward the killing of street children by police death squads.

The Brasilians, November, 1991

UNITED STATES

CIVIL RIGHTS BILL SIGNED

After two years of political dispute and one presidential veto, President Bush signed a civil rights bill on Thursday, November 21, stating "[A]ll I know is I can certify it is not a quota bill. It is a fair bill, and it is going to hit a lick against discrimination in the workplace, and I couldn't be more happy." Pressure from civil rights, religious, labor, and women's

organizations may have been the force that sparked Bush and Democratic senate leaders to reach a compromise on the bill. The new bill increases the chances for women and religious minorities to collect damages for job discrimination, and repeals Supreme Court decisions that made it harder for minorities to win job discrimination lawsuits.

BARRY SAYS FAREWELL

Former Washington, D.C. Mayor Marion Barry took his last opportunity to speak to supporters before beginning a six-month prison sentence. In his backyard, in front of a crowd of 200, Barry remarked, "I've admitted to you and all the world about my personal problems of drug and alcohol use and abuse. Incarceration is no cure for it." Convicted on one misdemeanor charge of cocaine possession, Barry was sentenced to serve six months at a minimum security prison in Petersburg, Va., in addition to paying a $5,000 fine and a $1,700 monthly fee to cover the costs of his prison stay.

JET TURNS FORTY

On November 18, 1991, Jet magazine published its 40th Anniversary Edition, celebrating four decades of providing an Afrocentric perspective in the world of journalism. The issue included a time line of Black historical events since 1951 and a pictorial retrospect of the past forty years of the Black American experience. As John H. Johnson, publisher of Jet, stated in the first issue on November 1, 1951, "In the world today everything is moving along at a faster pace. There is more news and far less time to read it. That's why we are introducing our news magazine Jet: to give Negroes [we were Negroes then] everywhere a weekly news magazine in handy pocket size form."

CAMPUS NEWS/ANNOUNCEMENTS

QUESTIONS OF IDENTITY? *THE OWL ANSWERS*

During late November and early December the George Houston Bass Auditorium in Rites and Reason was the site for the play, *The Owl Answers* written by Adrienne Kennedy and directed by Brown student, Rhonda Ross. The play "deals with a biracial womon trying to find her identity among the contradictions and discrepancies among the races." Ross feels many African-Americans whether bi- or multi-cultural don't realize how emotionally, psychologically, and emotionally torn they really are. *The Owl Answers* which was well received starred: Yoruba Richens, Donald King, June Lomena, Ron Brown, Kathy Moran, Matthew HorwitzAlan Maimon, Michael Douglas Hummel, Tanya Southerland, and Wendy Jehlen.

PART-TIME CHAPLIN MAKES FULL-TIME COMMITMENT

Earlier in the year, Debra Robinson Dixon was named Chaplin Intern for Minority Concerns. Chaplin Dixon's appointment filled the spot left by Chaplin Daphne Wiggins. Although Dixon is only at Brown on a part-time basis, she is quite involved in the Brown community. She is involved in leadership development projects within Voices of Inspiration, holds a weekly Bible study, and among other things is an advisor to SOAR. Students wishing to get in touch with Chaplin Dixon can catch her on Tuesdays during normal office hours at X2344 or during her Sunday service at 5:30 in Manning Chapel. Dixon is currently a Ph. D candidate at Boston University. Hopefully, the Brown Corporation will allocate funding so that she will be able to serve the Brown Third World community on a full-time basis.

THANK YOUS

THE EBONY SOIREE

On behalf of ASA and OUAP, we would like to take this opportunity to thank everyone who contributed to the success of the Ebony Soirée. Special thanks go to our co–sponsors, the Afro–American Studies Dept., Phi Beta Sigma Fraternity, SOCA, Third World Pre-Business Society, NAACP and NSBE for their financial and moral support. We are also grateful for the help of those members of ASA and OUAP who helped with planning and organization, publicity and the smooth running of the event itself. Finally, we would like to thank the community for supporting us with your presence which enabled us to raise over $180 for the John Hope Settlement Project. We hope you will attend similar events in the future. Once again, thank you.

Victor Williams — President, ASA

Camille Gear & Terrence Taylor — Co–Chairs, OUAP

PENNIES ADDING UP

The women of the Mu Kappa Chapter of the Sigma Gamma Rho Sorority, Inc. would like to thank everyone who supported the National Urban League during the Penny Drive. Over $150 was raised. We look forward to your support in the future.

BLACK HISTORY MONTH

As part of Black History Month, the African Students Association will be hosting its annual Cultural Evening on Saturday, Feb. 8, 1992. The event will consist of a fashion show, poetry readings, skits, songs and dance performances. Anyone interested in being a model, or who has clothes they would like included in the fashion show, should contact Jumi at x6525. If you would like to read a poem, perform a song or dance, or otherwise participate in the evening, please contact Lydia (x6318) or Victor (x6329) before Dec. 20th.

UWEZOS ARE IN!!

Uwezo copies are now available in the staffers' office of the TWC. Get ONE before they're gone. First come, first serve.

FAREWELL TO MID-YEAR GRADUATES

Congratulations Class of 1991.5. We've learned so much from you and will miss you dearly. The best of luch in all you pursue, and as an alumni, don't forget about the future Black students that will follow your footsteps. To you we wish the best.

I'M OUTTA HERE!

To my sistas and brothas of the classes of '92, '93, '94, & '95:

I love you all, but I've really got to go! Leaving this place where I've learned so much, grown in so many ways, met and loved so many people is a bittersweet event for me. I want you to know that the memories we've shared will be with me always.

Be blessed in all you endeavor. Get the most out of you Brown experience. This is one of the most liberal, diverse and prestigious institutions in the country. I know you've heard that before, but make a point to act on it. Learn about other cultures and schools of thought. Get the most out of your courses and extracurricular activities. These experiences can be invaluable. Make sure you remember all that you learn and share the knowledge with others who are not as fortunate to be exposed to so many issues. Most of all, make an effort to genuinely love and support your brothers and sisters, for there is no empowerment in disunity.

Keep the faith and always remember to lift as you climb.

---Ljillauna Watson, '91.5
(I'M OUTTA HERE!!)

THOUGHTS AND OPINIONS

The following are the thoughts and opinions of individuals in Brown's Black community. They do not necessarily reflect the opinions of the African Sun or the Organization of the United African People. Keep that in mind as you read. Enjoy.

TO BE OR NOT TO BE?

How many times have you heard the debate regarding our racial identification—are we Blacks or are we African-Americans? Some claim we should be Black because many of us cannot trace our roots to any specific African tribe or because our ties with Africa are so weak that they are nonexistent. Others feel we should be Black because that is what we have always been or it is just easier. Up until a few weeks ago, I really had not given it much thought; however, after getting into a discussion with what must have been three of Brown's most ignorant individuals, I pontificated heavily. Personally, I prefer the term African-American, not from a politically correct perspective but from a historical viewpoint.

True, very few of us in the community can trace our roots back to any specific African tribe, but we all know (whether we are willing to acknowledge it or not) that somewhere down the line some of our ancestors were African. If you feel as though you have nothing in common with or cannot relate to our African brothers and sisters, you are truly the product of this society's divide and conquer mentality. Granted for centuries, due to slavery, we were separated by the vast Atlantic, but blood is always thicker than water. All too often people in our community have the tendency, in an overtly Western manner, to scoff, ridicule, and jeer our African brothers and sisters. You see them all as "back-bush, jungle-bunny, tree-climbin', monkey-huntin', tribal-feudin', hut-makin', disease-spreadin' social, economic, and cultural retards." You laugh and make jokes at their different lifestyles, thinking that you are so superior. Ha, ha, ha, very funny...the joke is on you. When the white man looks at you and your African counterpart, he does not see the difference. That is not to say that our cultures or lifestyles are not starkly different. Our culture transformed, but it did so from its African foundation. Do not deny that.

For those who are satisfied with the status quo--Black--because that is what it has always been, I ask you what ever happened to negro, nigger, and colored? They were all phased out. Now is the time to establish a positive and meaningful name that ties us to a history rather than to an association with a negatively denoted color. This is our opportunity to regain the power lost by ethnic and racial dictation and to acknowledge and reaffirm our heritage. It may not be easy to make the transition to African-American, but it was not easy for slaves to rebel against slavery or for civil rights activists to protest racial injustice.

By choosing to be called African-Americans, we gain a senseof empowerment. We have sent the message to society that we have chosen a name that truly describes us. We are a people who have recognized not only the valuable contributions we have made to this country, but also the rich and diverse ancestry from which we have all sprung.

Realizing the vast bounds of the diaspora, the same arguments hold true for those of us that are African-Caribbean, African-South American, etc.

---J. Omari Johnson, '95

IT'S THE TRUTH, NO LYE!

Internalized oppression is a most powerful tool, yet many times it is utilized ignorantly, and its effects are quite detrimental. It is exceedingly difficult not to engage in internalized oppression when our race is confronted on every angle by a society that constantly rapes and degrades us. Until the Third World Transition Program, I was never aware of internalized oppression; yes, I have used it, but I never thought about it or realized what I was doing until we discussed it then. Now I am aware, and I make a conscious effort not to succumb to it, but the situation is somewhat more complex.

I graduated after eleven years from my predominantly white, affluent high school with a strong sense of who I am; I loved being a Black female, and I was proud of my race, but pissed because of our oppression. I learned a lot throughout my childhood, and I grew politically inclined in an attempt to try and "uplift my race." I developed an ethnocentricity that I still hold. As a senior, I cut off all my shoulder length hair and sported a nice afro. I was sick of wearing my hair to please other people, and I began to appreciate my naturally texturized hair. Currently, I LOVE my hair style, short twists. I have confronted my internalized oppression pertaining to hair and conquered it, but I am not yet free; I was forced also to confront my mother's hang-ups about my hair.

"They" say that the people who have most influenced your life are your parents, instilling in you your basic morals and values, many times equivalent to their own. Growing up in a somewhat worse environment in terms of race relations, my mother was constantly made to swallow the inferiority pill, and eventually she became addicted to it. People were good-looking based on their "grade" (not texture) of hair, and their features. In my household, my little brother was "fortunate" because he had "baby" or "good" hair.

Going home for Thanksgiving, I was confronted by my "very disappointed" and pissed mother who claimed that all the other kids come home from college looking decent, and I come home with some "nappy, short mess" in my hair. She calmly told me twenty-four/seven that my hair was hellish, and that I could not come home for Christmas unless I took that "shit" out. My constant response was "Mom, it may be your world, but it is my hair." She told me that I could not come on her job either because my hair was embarassing. Believe me, I was not really phased; I am

beyond the point where someone's disapproval of my lifestyle affects me. Nevertheless, she is my mother, and I love and respect her, so it was hard for me to confront her with the real problem, her constant use of internalized oppression, but I wanted the same respect.

But, I did. Finally, fed up, I talked to her about her internalized oppression and how it frustrated and hurt me. My little brother was like "yeah, mom you need to chill!" She realized that what I said was true, and she did have some hang-ups, but she said she was conscious of them now, and she would try to stop. It is hard to directly confront your parents about their beliefs, but I am so glad that I did because now my family is aware of how easy it is to fall into the trap of internalized oppression, and we can try to avoid it. My mother still admitted that she did not like my hair, but I know that she did not hate it...later that night, I saw her twisting some of her own hair. Things that make you say "hmm." Internalized oppression is something that we all use as a tool, but ironically, we are all the victims; hair is only one aspect, there are many more ways that we oppress ourselves.

---Tanya Southerland, '95

DON'T FORGET THE REASON FOR THE SEASON

As I prepare to return home to my family, and I realize I can't afford to engage in the commercialism behind present-day Christmases, I encourage you also to shy away from all the commmercialism. Remember that the birth of Jesus Christ is the reason for the season. As I grow older I've learned to appreciate what Christmas is really about. To me, Christmas is about Christ and family love. I challenge you to find the true meaning of Christmas to you and to celebrate it for the right reasons and in the right way.

---Nadirah Moreland, '94

EDITORS' NOTE

It's been a fast and at the same time a very long semester for many of us. The African Sun thanks everyone who submitted work and also appreciates the praise we have received. We welcome criticisms and suggestions for improvement and look forward to continuous support and participation. For those that doubted the power of OUAP, the organization and its two publications--Uwezo and African Sun--are back on the block. Hope to see you involved with OUAP and its affiliates. Have a safe and relaxing winter break.

WORD SEARCH-BLACK CIVIL RIGHTS LEADERS

From "A Salute to Black Civil Rights Leaders," Volume IV

N	E	M	M	H	G	N	I	N	W	O	D	E	G	R	O	E	G	T	L	M	C	N	W	B	C	T
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1. Daisy Bates
2. W.E.B. DuBois
3. George Downing
4. James Farmer
5. Marcus Garvey
6. Francis Grimke
7. Fannie Lou Hamer
8. George Haynes
9. Jesse Jackson
10. Malcolm X
11. Martin Luther King
12. John Mitchell
13. Isaac Myers
14. Asa Philip Randolph
15. Josephine Ruffin
16. Mary Talbert
17. Channing Tobias
18. Walter White
19. Whitney Young

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